

Averting Engels' pause: On the AI Action Summit in Paris

Energy **sustainability** and labour markets emerge as key priorities in AI Summit

Prime Minister Narendra Modi **highlighted** India's **stance** on the **evolving** Artificial Intelligence (AI) **landscape** at the AI Action Summit in Paris on February 11, **stressing** the need for "governance and standards that **uphold** our shared values, **address** risks, and build trust". This **perspective** is also **reflected** in the joint statement signed by India and over 50 other countries. **Commitments** to trust, safety, and universal access **align** well **with** India's efforts to advance AI technologies while **mitigating** risks. The nation's approach to AI will be crucial as the technology progresses and costs decline. **Innovations** such as Chinese firm DeepSeek's **breakthrough** reasoning models **underscore** the growing risks to labour markets. The IT and services sector **constitutes** a significant portion of India's economy but **employs** a relatively smaller workforce. AI-driven efficiency gains present an attractive business **proposition**, yet the **potential** for job losses or **stagnant** wage growth in this sector **poses** serious risks. The Prime Minister rightly **pointed out** that technological advancements historically create new employment opportunities. However, as noted in the Economic Survey, there is a valid concern regarding an Engels' pause, a phase where firms **reap** the benefits of new technology while **real wages stagnate**. India cannot afford even a brief period of such economic **strain**, making **proactive** policy responses essential.

The summit's **emphasis** on **sustainable** AI growth and energy efficiency **is** equally timely, **given** global climate **imperatives**. The United States produces more than twice the electricity of India, despite having just a **quarter** of its population. A growing share of this energy is now consumed by data centres, which power AI training and **deployment**. As AI-driven energy demand **surges**, ensuring that this growth is powered by renewable sources is critical. Commercial AI success remains **elusive**, with **substantial** investments flowing into top market players but offering limited financial returns. While India may not **replicate** this high-investment, low-return model, developing foundational AI models that are **tailored** to Indian needs is imperative. **Leveraging** emerging efficiencies and **maximising** AI's potential must remain central to India's strategy. The IndiaAI Mission's **initiatives**, such as subsidised access to Graphics Processing Unit (GPU) **clusters** and funding for **promising** projects, **are** encouraging steps toward this goal. Looking ahead, **integrating** AI education and skills training **at scale will** be essential. Even if a significant share of top AI talent moves abroad, India must ensure that its domestic industry retains sufficient **expertise** to remain competitive. AI will undoubtedly reshape industries, and **preparing** a **robust talent pipeline will** be key to ensuring that India not only **adapts** but also **thrives in** this transformation.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Avert** (verb) – Prevent, Avoid, Ward off, Forestall, Deter टालना
2. **Engels' pause** (noun) – A phase where technological advancements benefit firms but lead to stagnant wages.
3. **Summit** (noun) – Conference, Meeting, Assembly, Gathering, Forum शिखर सम्मेलन
4. **Sustainability** (noun) – Durability, Endurance, Viability, Longevity, Maintenance सततता
5. **Highlight** (verb) – Emphasize, Spotlight, Underscore, Accentuate, Feature प्रमुखता देना
6. **Stance** (noun) – Position, Attitude, Standpoint, Viewpoint, Perspective रुख
7. **Evolving** (adjective) – Developing, Changing, Progressing, Advancing, Transforming विकसित होना
8. **Landscape** (noun) – Scenario, Environment, Terrain, Setting, Context परिदृश्य
9. **Stress** (verb) – Emphasize, Highlight, Underline, Insist, Reiterate जोर देना
10. **Uphold** (verb) – Maintain, Support, Defend, Preserve, Sustain बनाए रखना
11. **Address** (verb) – Tackle, Handle, Resolve, Confront, Manage सुलझाना
12. **Perspective** (noun) – Viewpoint, Outlook, Angle, Standpoint, Approach दृष्टिकोण
13. **Reflect** (verb) – Mirror, Echo, Reproduce, Show, Indicate प्रतिबिंबित करना
14. **Align** (with) (verb) – Match, Adjust, Coordinate, Harmonize, Conform मेल खाना
15. **Mitigate** (verb) – Reduce, Alleviate, Lessen, Diminish, Ease कम करना
16. **Breakthrough** (noun) – Discovery, Innovation, Advancement, Milestone, Revolution सफलता
17. **Underscore** (verb) – Emphasize, Highlight, Stress, Accentuate, Reinforce जोर देना
18. **Constitute** (verb) – Form, Comprise, Make up, Represent, Compose गठित करना
19. **Employ** (verb) – Hire, Engage, Recruit, Utilize, Enlist नियुक्त करना
20. **Proposition** (noun) – Proposal, Offer, Suggestion, Plan, Idea प्रस्ताव
21. **Potential** (noun) – Possibility, Capability, Capacity, Promise, Prospect संभावना
22. **Stagnant** (adjective) – Static, Unchanging, Dormant, Idle, Inactive स्थिर
23. **Pose** (verb) – Present, Create, Cause, Raise, Introduce खड़ा करना

24. **Point out** (phrasal verb) – To indicate or mention something. इशारा करना
25. **Reap** (verb) – Gain, Obtain, Harvest, Acquire, Secure प्राप्त करना
26. **Real wage** (noun) – Wages adjusted for inflation, reflecting actual purchasing power
27. **Stagnate** (verb) – Stand still, Idle, Plateau, Stall, Languish ठहरना
28. **Strain** (noun) – Pressure, Stress, Tension, Burden, Load तनाव
29. **Proactive** (adjective) – Active, Initiative, Forward-looking, Preventive, Dynamic सक्रिय
30. **Sustainable** (adjective) – Eco-friendly, Renewable, Viable, Enduring, Maintainable टिकाऊ
31. **Given** (preposition) – Considering, Taking into account, In view of, Due to, Because of देखते हुए
32. **Imperative** (noun) – Necessity, Requirement, Essential, Obligation, Duty अनिवार्यता
33. **Quarter** (noun) – Part, Section, Segment, Division, Portion चौथाई
34. **Deployment** (noun) – Implementation, Utilization, Application, Rollout, Execution तैनाती
35. **Surge** (verb) – Rise, Increase, Escalate, Soar, Grow तेजी से बढ़ना
36. **Elusive** (adjective) – Evasive, Slippery, Hard to catch, Unattainable, Fleeting हाथ न आनेवाला
37. **Substantial** (adjective) – Significant, Considerable, Large, Ample, Sizeable पर्याप्त
38. **Replicate** (verb) – Copy, Duplicate, Reproduce, Mimic, Clone नकल करना
39. **Tailor** (verb) – Customize, Adapt, Modify, Shape, Adjust अनुकूल बनाना
40. **Leverage** (verb) – Utilize, Exploit, Harness, Use, Capitalize on उपयोग करना
41. **Maximise** (verb) – Optimize, Enhance, Increase, Boost, Amplify अधिकतम करना
42. **Cluster** (verb) – Group, Gather, Assemble, Collect, Bundle समूह बनाना
43. **Promising** (adjective) – Hopeful, Encouraging, Bright, Favorable, Propitious आशाजनक
44. **At scale** (phrase) – On a large or significant level. बड़े पैमाने पर
45. **Expertise** (noun) – Skill, Knowledge, Proficiency, Competence, Mastery विशेषज्ञता
46. **Robust** (adjective) – Strong, Sturdy, Resilient, Durable, Vigorous मजबूत

47. **Talent pipeline** (noun) – A system for developing and retaining skilled individuals.

48. **Adapt** (verb) – Adjust, Modify, Alter, Accommodate, Change अनुकूल बनना

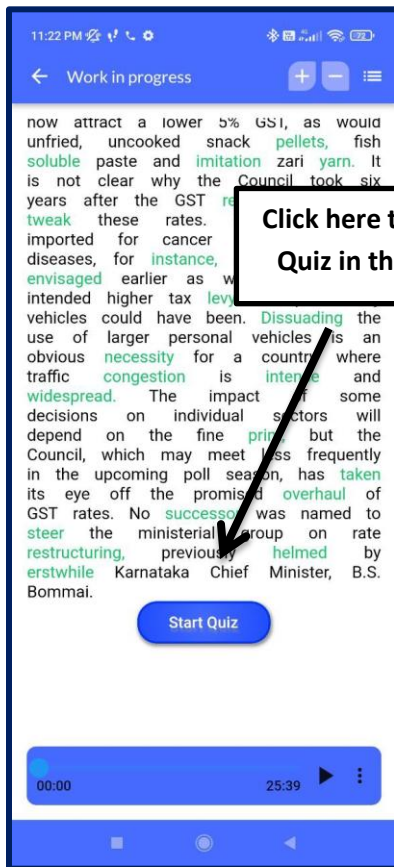
49. **Thrive in** (phrasal verb) – To grow or develop successfully in a particular environment. फलना-फूलना

@mocks_wallah

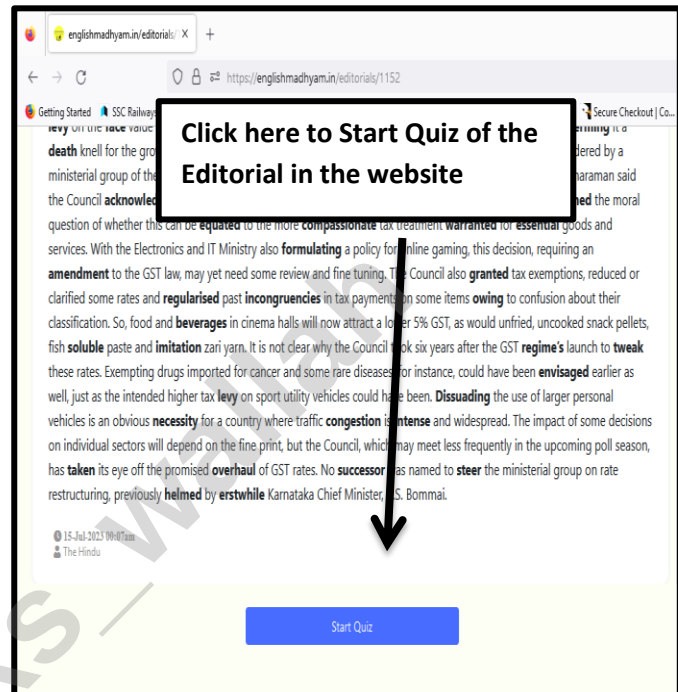
Summary of the Editorial

1. **AI Action Summit:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi emphasized the need for governance and standards in AI at the Paris AI Action Summit on February 11.
2. **Shared Values:** India, along with over 50 countries, committed to trust, safety, and universal access in AI development.
3. **Labour Market Risks:** AI advancements, like DeepSeek's reasoning models, pose risks to labour markets, particularly in India's IT and services sector.
4. **Engels' Pause Concern:** The Economic Survey warns of an Engels' pause, where firms benefit from AI while real wages stagnate, potentially straining India's economy.
5. **Job Creation vs. Job Loss:** While AI can create new jobs, the risk of job losses or stagnant wages in key sectors like IT remains a significant challenge.
6. **Energy Sustainability:** The summit highlighted the importance of sustainable AI growth, as AI-driven energy demand, particularly from data centres, surges globally.
7. **Renewable Energy:** Ensuring AI growth is powered by renewable energy is critical to aligning with global climate goals.
8. **US-India Energy Comparison:** The US produces more than twice India's electricity with a quarter of its population, highlighting India's need for energy-efficient AI solutions.
9. **Commercial AI Challenges:** Despite heavy investments, commercial AI success remains limited, with low financial returns for top market players.
10. **India's AI Strategy:** India must focus on developing foundational AI models tailored to its needs rather than replicating high-investment, low-return global models.
11. **IndiaAI Mission:** Initiatives like subsidised GPU access and funding for AI projects are steps toward building a robust AI ecosystem.
12. **AI Education and Skills:** Scaling AI education and skills training is essential to prepare a competitive workforce for the AI-driven future.
13. **Talent Retention:** India must ensure it retains sufficient AI expertise domestically, even as top talent migrates abroad.
14. **Industry Transformation:** AI will reshape industries, and India must adapt proactively to thrive in this transformation.
15. **Proactive Policies:** Addressing risks like Engels' pause and ensuring sustainable AI growth will require proactive policy measures and strategic planning.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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